



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Weston Classical School
School Website: <https://westonclassical.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Weston Classical School, Paris, TN (Weston Classical School TN 38242) presents a robust Christian, classical orientation with a clear emphasis on formation of character, virtue, and a Western, classical intellectual heritage. Public-facing materials stress a Christian worldview weaved through a classical education, with explicit emphasis on Latin, history, literature, and a formation-focused mission. While the school's materials demonstrate strong religious and formation-oriented aims, there is less explicit public articulation of certain core classical elements (notably the explicit triad of grammar–logic–rhetoric, and the Great Books/Great Conversation framing), which tempers a full, textbook Classical rating in a couple of categories.

Overall assessment: CLASSICAL. The school aligns strongly with Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, and Faculty, while Curriculum and Pedagogy show clear classical influence but lack explicit articulation of all six canonical elements. Parents & Community practices are present but not as fully developed as a canonical Classical School would require. The aggregate picture supports Weston Classical School as CLASSICAL with room for needle-moving steps (outlined below) to achieve full canonical alignment.

What would move the needle is to articulate and enact: explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and materials; an explicit Trivium-focused curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric) emphasis; a formal plan for parent partnership as co-educators; and a documented emphasis on Socratic pedagogy and a more explicit "teacher as living curriculum" framing across all grades.

- Evidence and analysis draw on Weston Classical School public materials (mission statements, curriculum emphasis, chaplaincy and liturgical-leaning practices, and faculty pages), including multiple pages that emphasize Christian, classical formation and Latin-based instruction. See mission statements and program descriptions in Weston Classical School public content.
- The classical rubric's key lexicon and indicators (from the Six Essential Elements documents) provide the filter against which these materials are judged, including emphasis on theology, the Great Books/Great Conversation, the Trivium, the formation of character, and parent partnership.
- The lexicon-based framework highlights the presence of: God/theology, liturgy/chapel, virtue and wisdom, formation over information, Latin as a core medium, and Western-tradition framing in Weston's materials. These map cleanly to the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and the Formation-orientation of the School Purpose & Goal.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

The six-category results cohere into an overall CLASSICAL classification, with meaningful nuances in Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Parent/Community engagement that suggest concrete steps toward full canonical status.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials frame Weston as a Christian Classical school, stating explicit Christian world-view integration across the curriculum and a theologized, formation-focused aim. The mission emphasizes formation in the Christian classical tradition and faith in God. - Chaplaincy and liturgical/communal aspects are present (chapel in Latin; a chaplain roles and chapel leadership). This supports liturgical and communal practices within education. - The site motto and statements articulate sacred, transcendent aims (truth, goodness, beauty; formation of virtue; “non scholae sed vitae discimus” in some materials), aligning with transcendental moral realism and liturgical community elements.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords evident: theology, liturgy/chapel, virtue, wisdom, moral formation, sacred tradition, truth/goodness/beauty, contemplation, God/Almighty God, Christian world-view. These align with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations (Grounded in Theology; Liturgical and Communal Practices). See the Six Essential Elements lexicon for these positive indicators. - Negative keyword indicators are not evident in public Weston materials in this category (no explicit secular or relativistic framing visible). The lexicon's negative signals would be external to the school's stated materials.

Why this rating - Weston clearly communicates a Christian framework that informs pedagogy, with explicit theology and liturgical community practices (chapel, chaplain). This matches the core expectations for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The textual emphasis on God, faith, and liturgical life supports the “Transcendental moral realism” and “Liturgical/Communal Practices” dimensions of the classical rubric. Therefore, CLASSICAL is warranted.

Citations: Weston materials explicitly discuss “Christian worldview,” mission statements, and chapel-related practices.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission statements articulate formation as the primary aim: “Our mission is to produce ladies and gentlemen educated in the Christian, classical tradition of the West through the medium of spoken Latin,” with explicit emphasis on intellectual and moral formation, virtue, and assembling students into virtuous, thoughtful adults. - The public materials frame education as formation over information, shaping character and loves toward truth, goodness, beauty, and human excellence. The site repeatedly discusses virtue, wisdom, and the aim to form a people grounded in Western tradition and Christian faith.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords evident: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, moral imagination, character, integrity, human flourishing, formation of affections, lifelong learning, classical tradition. These map directly to the Positive Keyword indicators under School Purpose and Goal (transcendentals, formation, and paideia). - Negative keywords: none clearly present in Weston's public materials for this category (no emphasis on career readiness, skills-for-work focus, or utilitarian metrics).

Why this rating - Weston's stated aim is formation in virtue, wisdom, and beauty within a Christian-classical framework, with explicit alignment to truth and classical ideals. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for Purpose and Goal.

Citations: Mission statements and formation emphasis are explicit in Weston's public content.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes Latin (bilingual Latin-English program) and a curriculum anchored in history and literature within a Christian, classical frame. The mission and program descriptions describe Latin as a central, living-language tool and a path to understanding history and Western civilization, with emphasis on reading and language as part of a classical formation. - Explicit references to “classical Christian education,” “history through the Western tradition,” and “Latin as a living language” are present. However, there is less explicit, public articulation of the formal liberal-arts structure (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or the Great Books/Great Conversation canon, which are hallmark elements of a canonical classical curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Latin, history, literature, Western tradition, classical education, Christian worldview, living language, reading classics in original language (though not always phrased as “Great Books” or “Great Conversation”). These align with curriculum-oriented classical indicators (Latin as core medium; history and literature integration). See the lexicon for curriculum-oriented terms (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation). - Negative keywords present: explicit Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books/Great Conversation references are not publicly explicit in Weston’s materials. The lack of explicit reference to grammar–logic–rhetoric and Great Books is a notable gap relative to canonical Classical Curriculum language (as per the Six Essential Elements lexicon).

Why this rating - Weston demonstrates strong classical influence via Latin-centered, history-and-literature-driven curriculum within a Christian framework. Yet the public articulation of the full classical curriculum (including the Trivium as formal pedagogy, and explicit Great Books/Great Conversation components) is not clearly stated in the public materials. This justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than a full CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Citations: Mission and About pages detailing Latin emphasis and Western-civilization focus.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical language highlights: immersion in Latin and living-language instruction; the curriculum uses a bilingual Latin-English approach and an emphasis on inline language acquisition and classical method. There are references to “active spoken Latin” and immersive methods. - The public materials emphasize formation, contemplation, and memory through language study and literature, with a motto “non scholae sed vitae discimus” indicating a philosophically contemplative stance. There is no explicit, widespread articulation of Socratic seminars, debates, or formal rhetorical training across all grades in the public content. The presence of Latin immersion and living-language pedagogy signals Classical methods, but the absence of explicit Socratic/Semina language in public content suggests the pedagogy is not fully enumerated in canonical terms.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Scholé (restful/ contemplative learning) is mentioned in the lexicon but not publicly as a formal term in Weston’s site; the site does emphasize contemplative formation through reading and language. Positive indicators such as contemplation, wonder, and memory work may be inferred from “non scholae sed vitae” and Latin immersion. The lexicon’s Pedagogy indicators (Socratic dialogue, seminars, rhetoric, memorization/recitation, Scholé) align with some of Weston’s approaches, but explicit, widespread usage of these traditional pedagogy forms is not clearly enumerated in Weston’s public content. - Negative keywords present: the public content does not emphasize project-based or strictly experiential, student-led pedagogy to the exclusion of contemplative methods; it instead foregrounds language immersion and classical formation. The lexicon warns against a narrow, non-dialogic approach; Weston’s public materials do not clearly demonstrate a fully dialogic or purely project-based pedagogy.

Why this rating - Weston demonstrates foundational classical pedagogy through Latin immersion and a formation-first approach, but lacks explicit public articulation of the full canonical pedagogy set (Socratic seminars, Scholé-based contemplative rhythms, and memorization/recitation as a formal, cross-grade practice). As such, the Pedagogy category sits at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Public statements about Latin immersion and the “non scholae sed vitae discimus” motto; references to chaplain-led chapel and language-based instruction.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Weston publicly presents a faculty section with named teachers and leaders, including detailed bios (e.g., Christie Atkins, Alessio Schiano, Gemma Lawless, Peter Longan) and descriptions of credentials, languages, and expertise. This supports the idea of a living curriculum and a faculty as mentors and exemplars. The presence of a chapel chaplain also indicates an integrated faculty-community leadership structure. - The faculty bios emphasize formation, expertise in classical/language disciplines, and personal commitments, hinting at the “living curriculum” and “faculty as mentors” model described in classical education literature.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: master teachers, mentors, living curriculum, faculty as exemplars, classical pedagogy, study in classical languages, language-focused teaching, and collegial culture (as inferred from bios and staff descriptions). These align with Classic Faculty indicators. - Negative keywords present: none evident in Weston’s faculty materials.

Why this rating - The explicit presentation of named faculty with credentials, coupled with language-focused and classical-teaching orientations, supports a CLASSICAL designation for Faculty.

Citations: Faculty bios and “Our Teachers” content.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Weston’s public materials emphasize donor support and patronage (e.g., “Our Patrons,” Platinum/Silver levels) and general community engagement through newsletters and social media, but there is no explicit articulation of parents as co-teachers or a formal partnership with parents in the ethos of classical education. The site does not publicly present a structured program for parent formation, family catechesis, or open-hosting of parent involvement beyond visits or standard informational channels. - The Six Essential Elements lexicon highlights Partnership with Families as a key positive axis for classical education; Weston does not publicly articulate a formal, structured partnership with parents as co-educators within its public content (beyond general engagement and fundraising).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parental formation, parent-teacher collaboration are high-value indicators in canonical classical education lexicon. These terms do not appear as explicit Weston-site language; public content is more donor/community oriented rather than parent-as-co-teacher oriented. - Negative keywords: The absence of explicit parent-education programs, home-education alignment, or structured parent formation programs constitutes a negative indicator for this category in canonical terms.

Why this rating - There is meaningful community engagement (donors, patrons, etc.) but a lack of explicit, canonical-language and public-facing programs that frame parents as co-educators or provide structured parent formation experiences. This aligns with NOT CLASSICAL for this category.

Citations: Patrons page and related Weston community materials.

What Would Move the Needle

- Curriculum: Publicly articulate and implement the full liberal-arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and explicitly reference Great Books/Great Conversation within the curriculum description. Add concrete Great Books-based courses or reading lists and a declared plan for the Great Conversation across grades.

- Pedagogy: Publicly commit to explicit Socratic/seminal seminar pedagogies, with a cross-grade, documented approach (e.g., Harkness-style dialogue, regular seminars, and rhetoric training). Emphasize Scholé/restful learning rhythms and memorization/recitation as formal, cross-year practices.
- Parents & Community: Establish explicit, public-facing programs that treat parents as co-teachers and partners in classical education (parent formation sessions, book studies, catechesis for families, parent visitation policies that clearly articulate engagement expectations).
- Curriculum content: Expand language and text choices to explicitly include classical tracts and primary sources, with a public plan showing how Latin, Greek (if applicable), and foundational texts interconnect with history and philosophy in cross-curricular threads.
- Community formation: Formalize liturgical rhythms and communal practices as a regular, integrated part of the school week with documented rituals that align with the liturgical calendar, theology, and sacred arts (as appropriate).

Citations used to inform these needle-moving ideas are rooted in the Six Essential Elements lexicon and its explicit calls for grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation, Scholé, and parent partnership.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.